



Unhappy service

This Zippo by artist Bradford Edwards—engraved with a quote from Czech historian Konstantin Josef Jireček—is a copy of a lighter used by a GI in Vietnam. Soldiers often had their lighters engraved with words showing dark humor, disillusionment, and references to death.

Incremental exit

US troops were withdrawn from Vietnam in a series of incremental “redeployments” under the codename Keystone. The first troops withdrawn, the Ninth Infantry Division, departed Vietnam in June 1969 in Operation Keystone Eagle. More followed: Keystone Cardinal, in late 1969, withdrew 45,000 US troops, and Keystone Bluejay, in spring 1970, saw another 50,000 return home. The troops sent home came from various branches of the military, so